

Psalms 27

Light, Salvation, and Waiting

The Lord is my light and my salvation

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *The LORD is my light and my salvation; whom shall I fear? the LORD is the strength of my life; of whom shall I be afraid?*
- 2 *When the wicked, even mine enemies and my foes, came upon me to eat up my flesh, they stumbled and fell.*
- 3 *Though an host should encamp against me, my heart shall not fear: though war should rise against me, in this will I be confident.*
- 4 *One thing have I desired of the LORD, that will I seek after; that I may dwell in the house of the LORD all the days of my life, to behold the beauty of the LORD, and to enquire in his temple.*
- 5 *For in the time of trouble he shall hide me in his pavilion: in the secret of his tabernacle shall he hide me; he shall set me up upon a rock.*
- 6 *And now shall mine head be lifted up above mine enemies round about me: therefore will I offer in his tabernacle sacrifices of joy; I will sing, yea, I will sing praises unto the LORD.*
- 7 *Hear, O LORD, when I cry with my voice: have mercy also upon me, and answer me.*
- 8 *When thou saidst, Seek ye my face; my heart said unto thee, Thy face, LORD, will I seek.*
- 9 *Hide not thy face far from me; put not thy servant away in anger: thou hast been my help; leave me not, neither forsake me, O God of my salvation.*
- 10 *When my father and my mother forsake me, then the LORD will take me up.*
- 11 *Teach me thy way, O LORD, and lead me in a plain path, because of mine enemies.*
- 12 *Deliver me not over unto the will of mine enemies: for false witnesses are risen up against me, and such as breathe out cruelty.*
- 13 *I had fainted, unless I had believed to see the goodness of the LORD in the land of the living.*
- 14 *Wait on the LORD: be of good courage, and he shall strengthen thine heart: wait, I say, on the LORD.*

2 · CONTEXT

Psalm 27 unites bold confidence in the face of armies and enemies with tender longing to dwell in God's house and behold His beauty, before turning to urgent petition when God's face seems hidden, and closing with the well-known exhortation to "wait on the Lord." Henry observes the psalm's emotional range—from fearless courage to near desperation to settled counsel—showing that real faith is not flat but moves through the full range of human experience while consistently returning to God as its anchor.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-3

Confident declaration: the Lord is light, salvation, and strength, so no army or war need be feared. Even wicked enemies who would "eat up" his flesh stumble and fall, because David's heart will not fear though war rises against him.

Verse 4-6

David's one deep desire: to dwell in the Lord's house all his days, to behold His beauty, and to inquire in His temple. God's hiding him in trouble, setting him upon a rock, and lifting him above enemies leads to sacrifices of joy and singing.

Verse 7-10

A shift in tone to urgent plea: hear, have mercy, answer; do not hide Your face or cast off in anger, You who have been David's help. Even if father and mother were to forsake him, the Lord would take him up—a striking statement of God's surpassing faithfulness.

Verse 11-14

Petition for a plain path away from enemies and false witnesses, paired with confident hope of seeing "the goodness of the Lord in the land of the living." The psalm closes with the famous exhortation to himself and the reader: "Wait on the Lord: be of good courage, and he shall strengthen thine heart."

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

True courage and longing for God’s presence can coexist with honest seasons of feeling God’s face is hidden, and the resolution in every case is the same counsel: wait on the Lord with strengthened, courageous hearts.

Application for life today.

Notice how this psalm moves from bold confidence to raw plea to settled counsel—give yourself permission for that same range rather than expecting constant, uniform feelings of faith. Cultivate David’s “one thing” desire (v. 4) to simply be with God, not only to get help from Him. And when answers are delayed, practice the closing exhortation actively—“wait on the Lord” is a command to obey, not just a feeling to have.

5 • REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. Which part of this psalm’s emotional range—bold confidence, urgent plea, or settled waiting—most matches where you are today?
2. What would it mean to make David’s “one thing” desire in verse 4 more central to your own relationship with God?
3. What specific situation right now calls you to “wait on the Lord” rather than force a resolution?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).